

STEAM-3D

Sustainable Training in Epidemiological Analysis and Modelling for Data-Driven Decision Making in Africa

SOUTH AFRICA | MALAWI | MOZAMBIQUE | CAMEROON | BELGIUM

Global Health EDCTP3

CEPI Co-funded by the European Union & CEPI

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The project is supported by Global Health EDCTP3 and its members

Introducing knowledge translation

Primer for STEAM3D delegates

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Health Systems Research Unit, SAMRC
Cochrane Africa

Acknowledgement

- Bey-Marrie Schmidt, SAMRC and Nasreen Jessani, Stellenbosch University – senior experts in KT

- Evidence-Informed Decision Making: The Art, Science and Complexity of Knowledge Translation. Center for Evidence-Based Health Care, Stellenbosch University

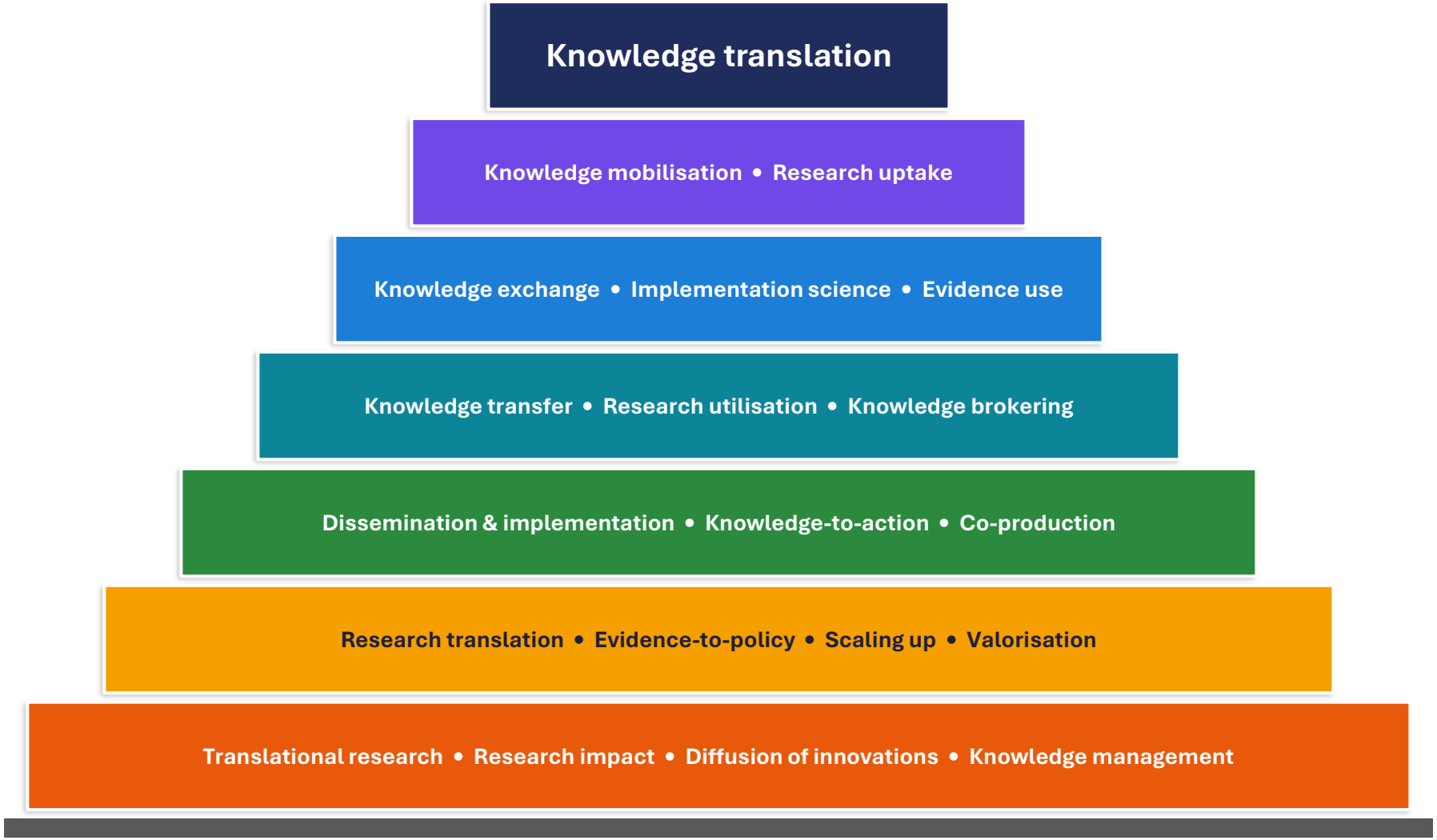
- Cochrane Knowledge Translation Evaluation Support Project

Think of a research project, publication, report or other output that you want to communicate to increase its impact

Who do you wish knew about the results?

As we go through the session – think about that interest holder and how you may communicate your findings.

Knowledge translation - A Tower of Babel?



100

terms for KT collected

46

used in titles/abstracts of KT articles

Many names, one goal: getting evidence into action

Source: McKibbon KA, et al. A cross-sectional study of the number and frequency of terms used to refer to knowledge translation in a body of health literature in 2006: a Tower of Babel? Implement Sci. 2010;5:16.

Learning objectives

- Outline definition and principles of knowledge translation
- Introduce approaches for interest holder mapping and analysis
- Briefly describe the steps of developing a knowledge translation strategy

Definition

"**Knowledge translation** is the exchange, synthesis, and effective communication of reliable and relevant research results.

The focus is on promoting interaction among the producers and users of research, removing the barriers to research use, and tailoring information to different target audiences so that effective interventions are used more widely."

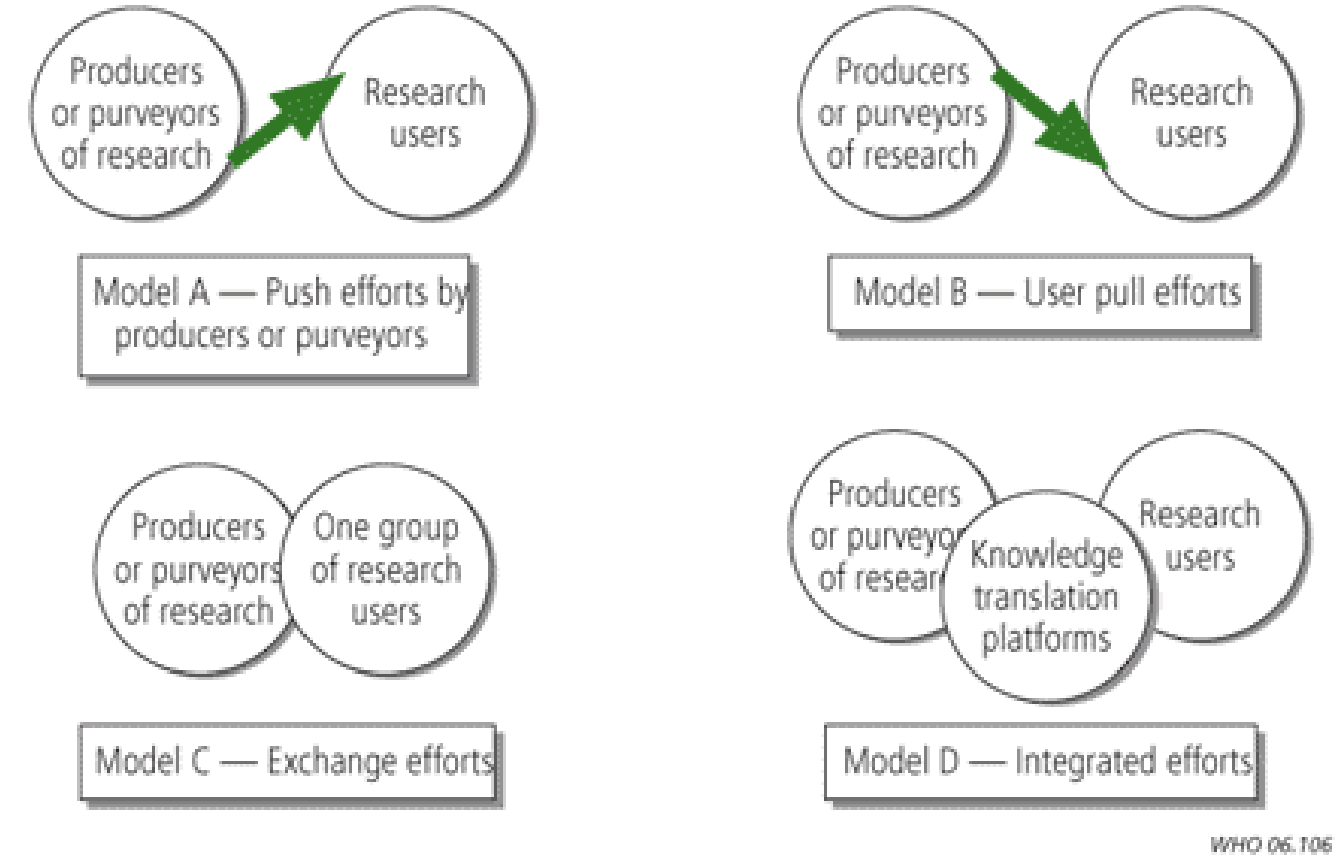
- Canadian Institutes of Health Research

Getting
the right **information**
to the right **people**
in the right **format**
at the right **time**
at the right **place**
in the right **way**
to influence (policy and practice) decision-making.

- Center for Evidence-Based Health Care, Stellenbosch University

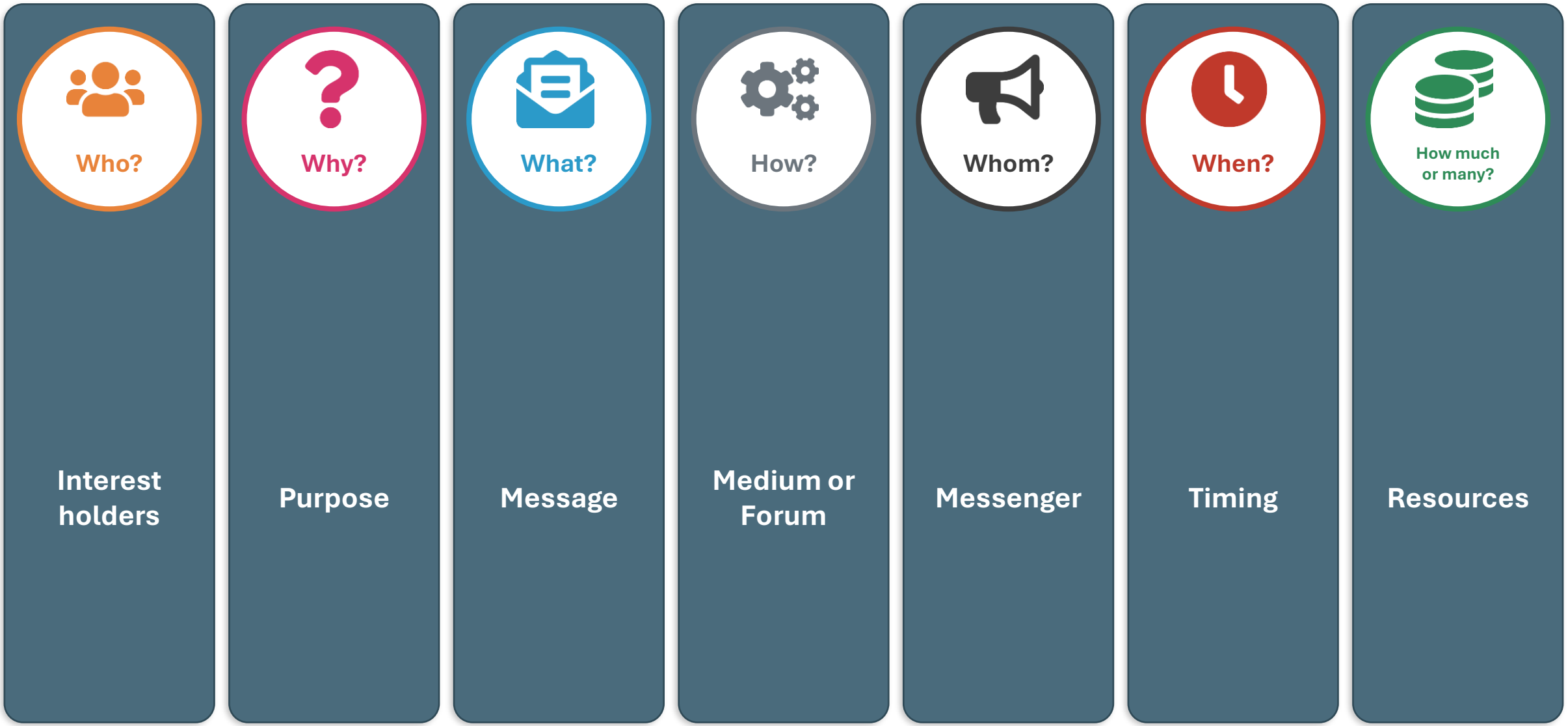
Different KT models

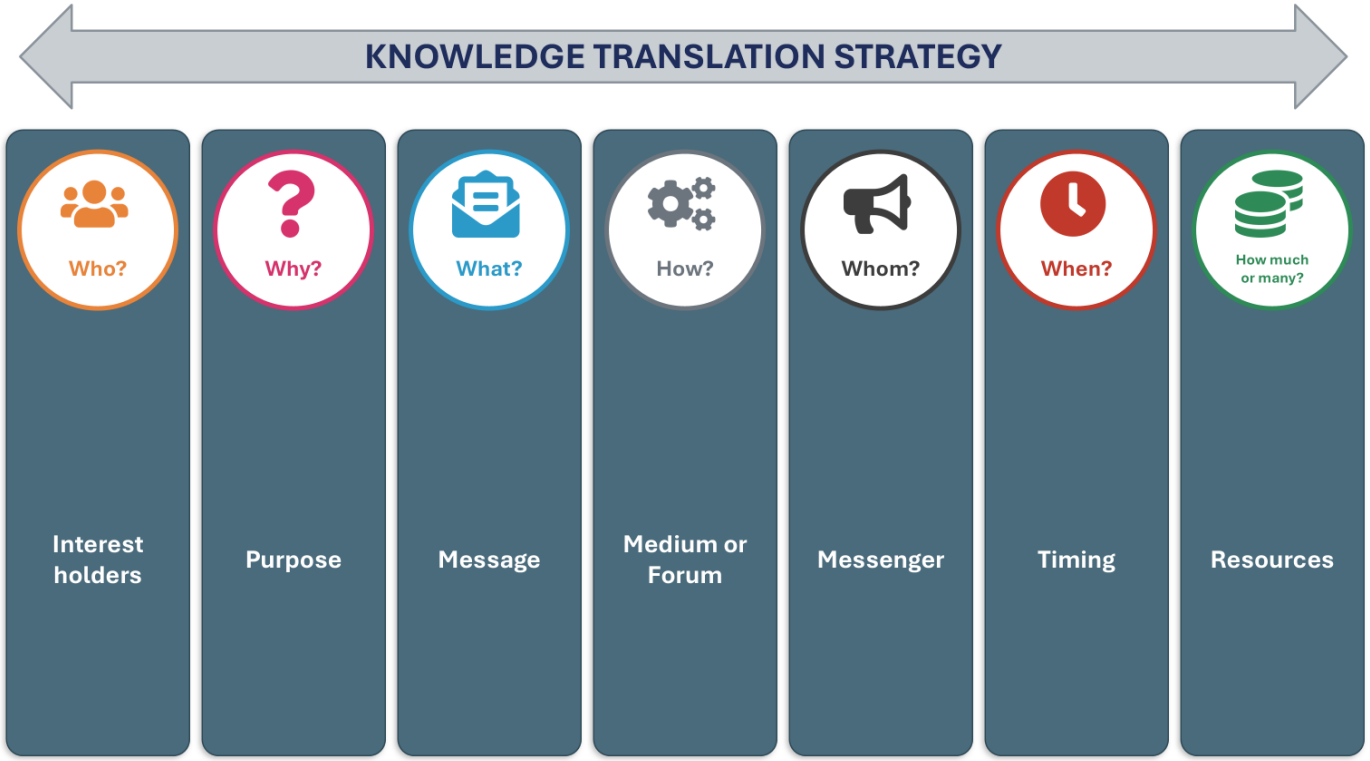
Fig. 2. **Models for linking research to action**



Lavis JN, Lomas J, Hamid M, Sewankambo NK. Assessing country-level efforts to link research to action. *Bull World Health Organ*. 2006;84(8):620–628. doi:10.2471/BLT.06.030312

KNOWLEDGE TRANSLATION STRATEGY





Interest holders:
e.g. students, guideline panellists, policymakers, other researchers, funders, media etc.

Timing: e.g. when, date

Resources:
e.g. time, human resources, financial costs, tools

Purpose:
e.g. raise awareness, interest, inform, clarify, effect policy or practice

Message:
e.g. a specific research finding, a call to action

Medium:
e.g. policy brief, journal article, infographic, video, press statement

Forum:
meeting, conference, telephone call, radio, social media, website

Messenger:
e.g. yourself, your colleague, community member, knowledge broker, media

1. WHO? Interest holders

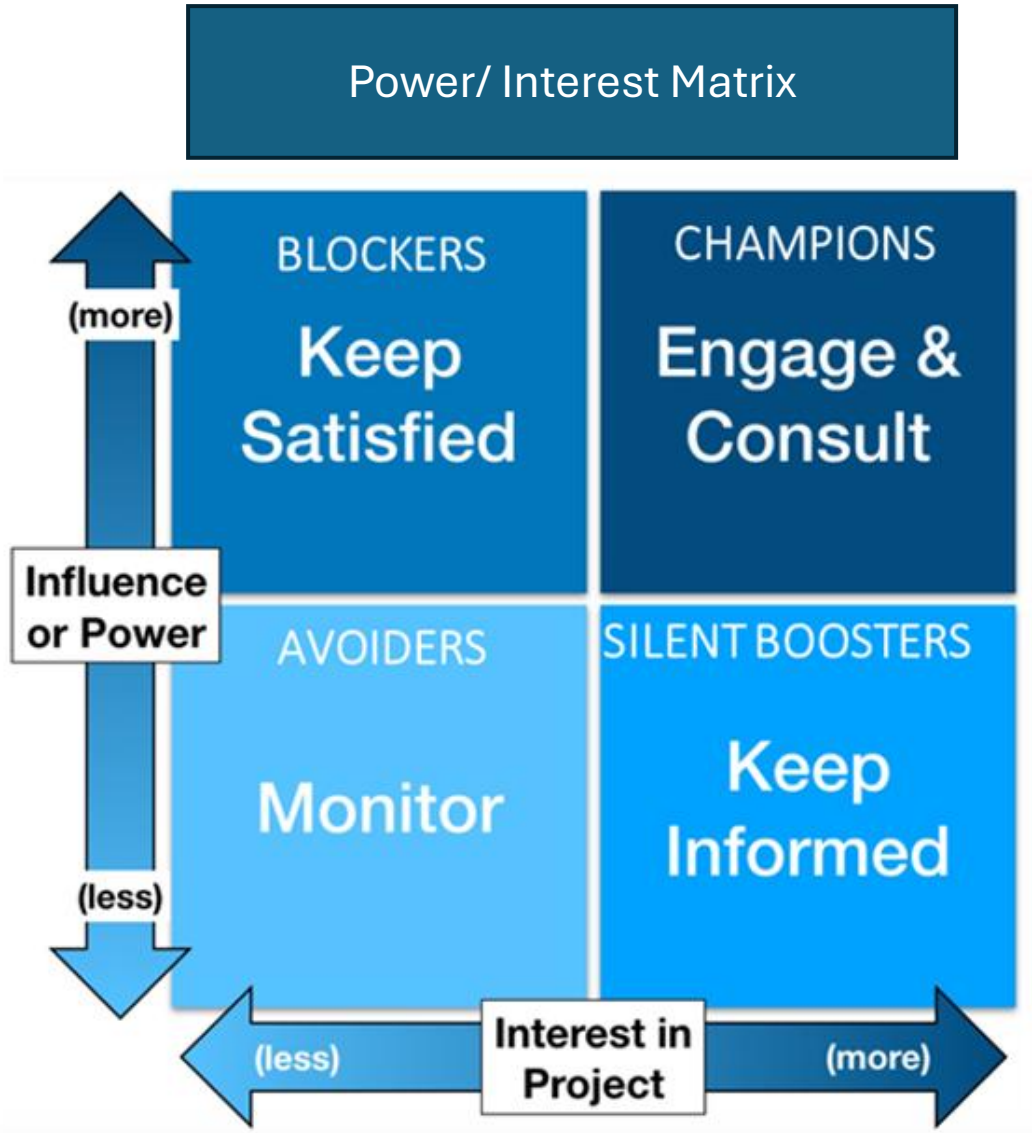
"Interest-holders" are "groups with legitimate interests in the health issue under consideration."

- A person, group or organization that has interest or concern about an issue.
- Can have a (positive/negative) interest in the results, proposed outcomes and policy actions of your research
- Not all interest holders are equal.

Akl EA, Khabsa J, Petkovic J, Magwood O, Lytvyn L, Motilall A, Campbell P, Todhunter-Brown A, Schünemann HJ, Welch V, Tugwell P, Concannon TW. "Interest-holders": a new term to replace "stakeholders" in the context of health research and policy. Cochrane Evid Synth Methods. 2024;2(11):e70007. doi:10.1002/cesm.70007

Types of interest holders

Active Resisters **Blockers**	Active Supporters **Champions**
Passive Resisters **Avoiders**	Passive Supporters **Silent Boosters**



Source: The Power Management Blueprint

Interest holder mapping

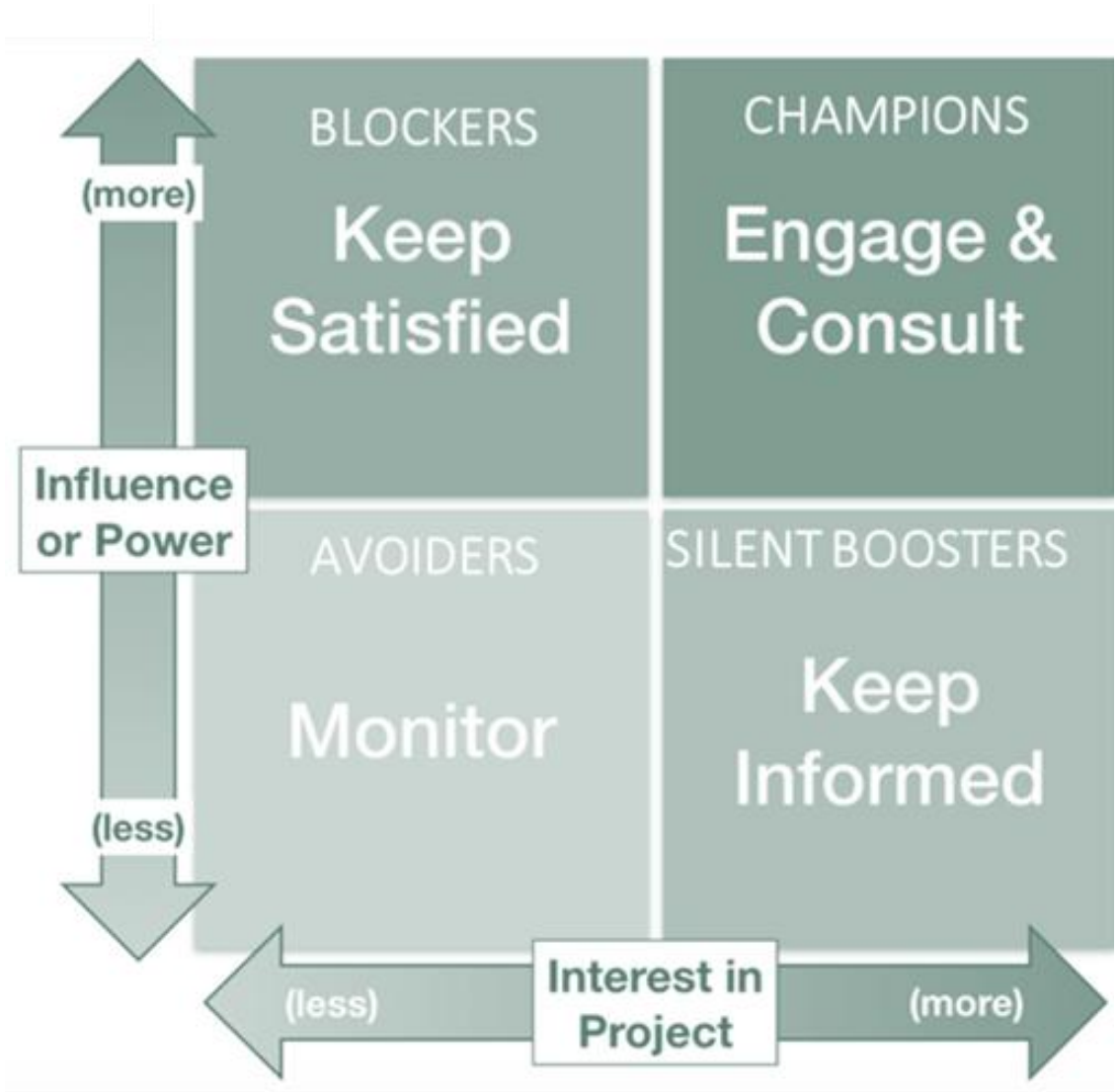


- Brainstorm all relevant interest holders
- Some are obvious, but also think of interest holders who are often neglected
- Not all interest holders will be a priority
- Which interest holders to prioritise may change over time

Interest holder analysis

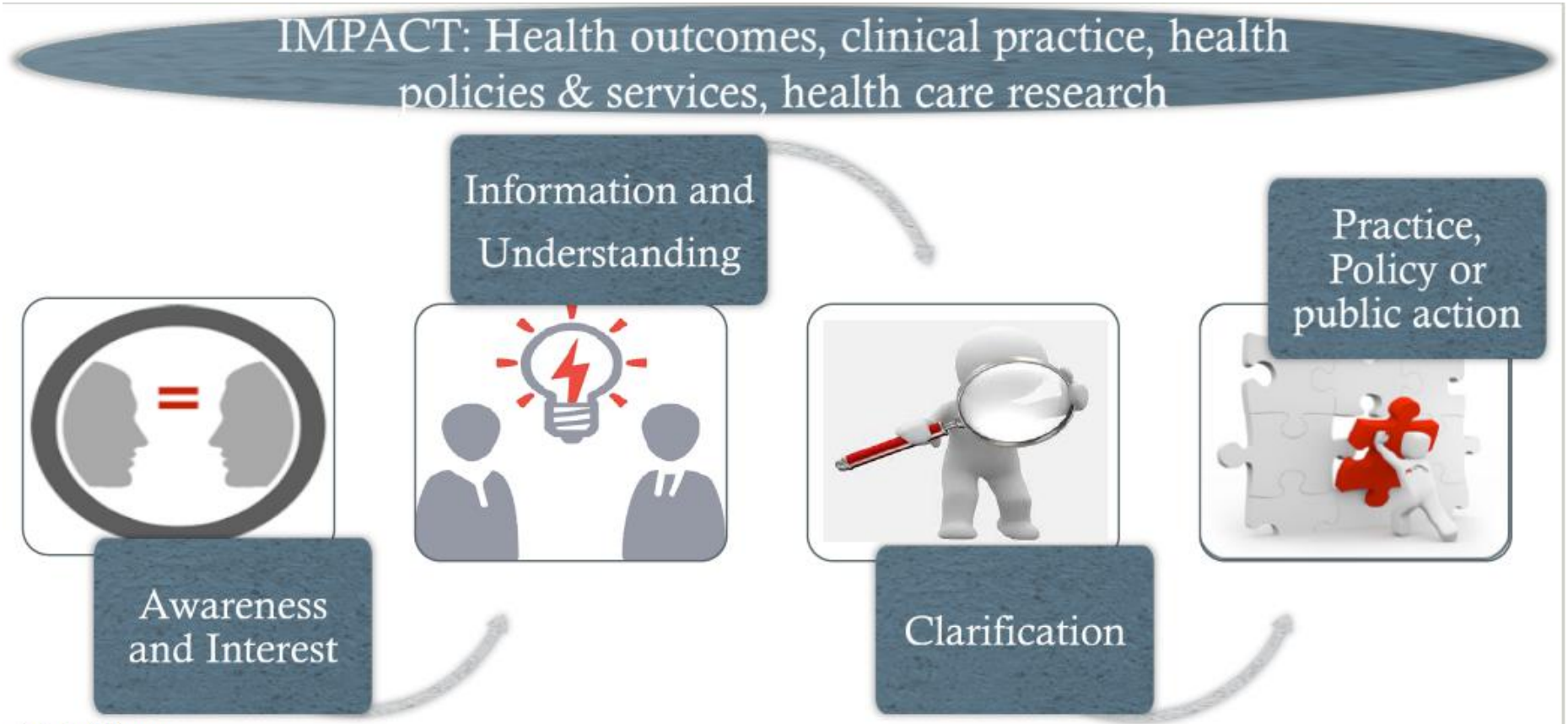
- Identify priority stakeholders
- Be aware of different interests towards and influences on your work
- Interest holder analysis will help to plan impactful activities to communicate your work and influence decision-making

Power/Interest Matrix



Source: The Power Management Blueprint

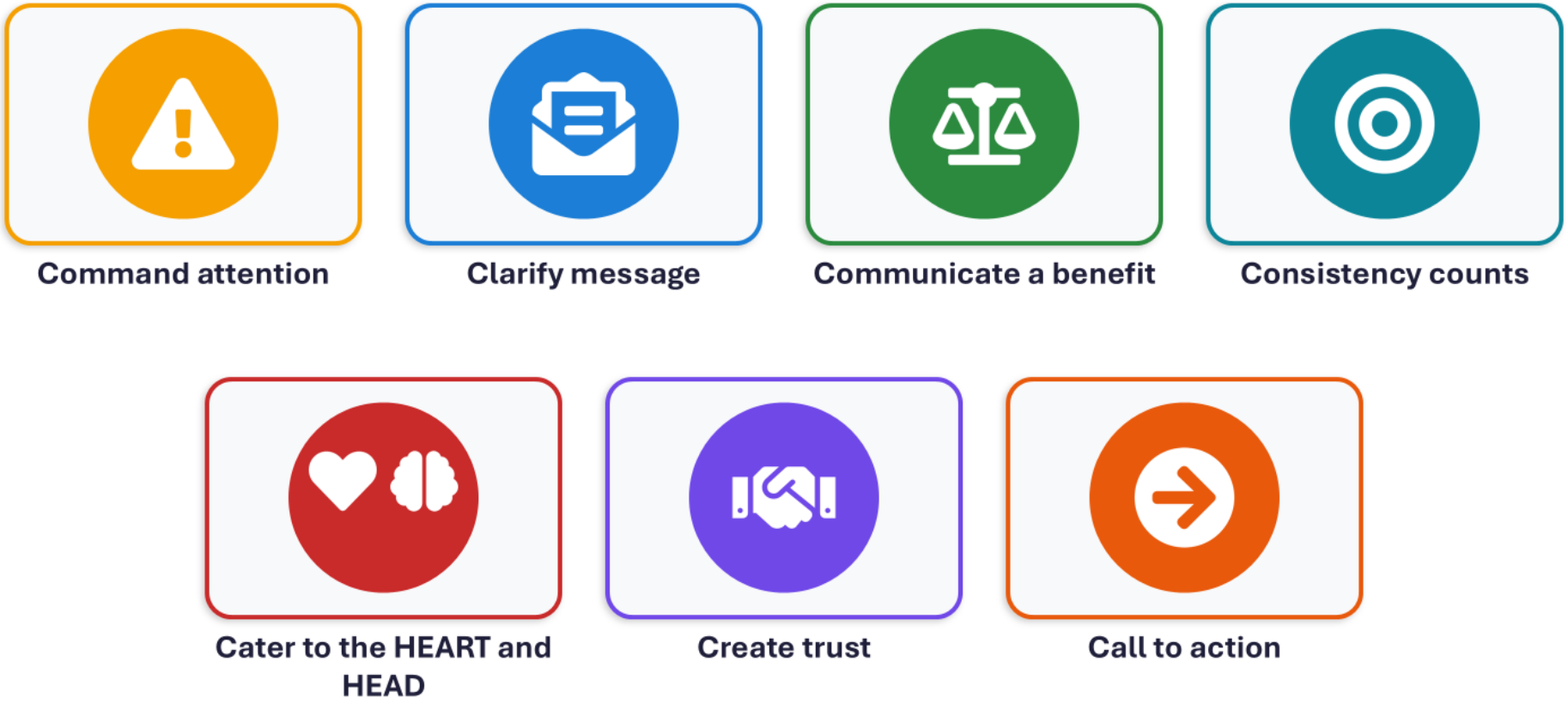
2. WHY? Purpose



Adapted from:

1) Stryer, Hubbard, Tunis & Clancy. 2000. Health services Research 35:5 Part 1
2) Harmworth and Turpin. 2001. *Creating an Effective Dissemination Strategy. An Expanded Interactive Workbook for Educational Development Projects.* Bridging the Gap – innovations Project
3) Barwick, M "Getting to Impact: Why Knowledge Translation Matters for Researchers with Melanie Barwick" https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xzmLrUIkONs

3. WHAT? Message



Source: WHO presentation. Global Communications Learning Programme. Module 1: Communication basics.

4. HOW? Medium / Forum



Newspapers



Radio & podcasts



Cartoons



Meetings & dialogues



Infographics



Journal articles



Policy briefs



TikTok



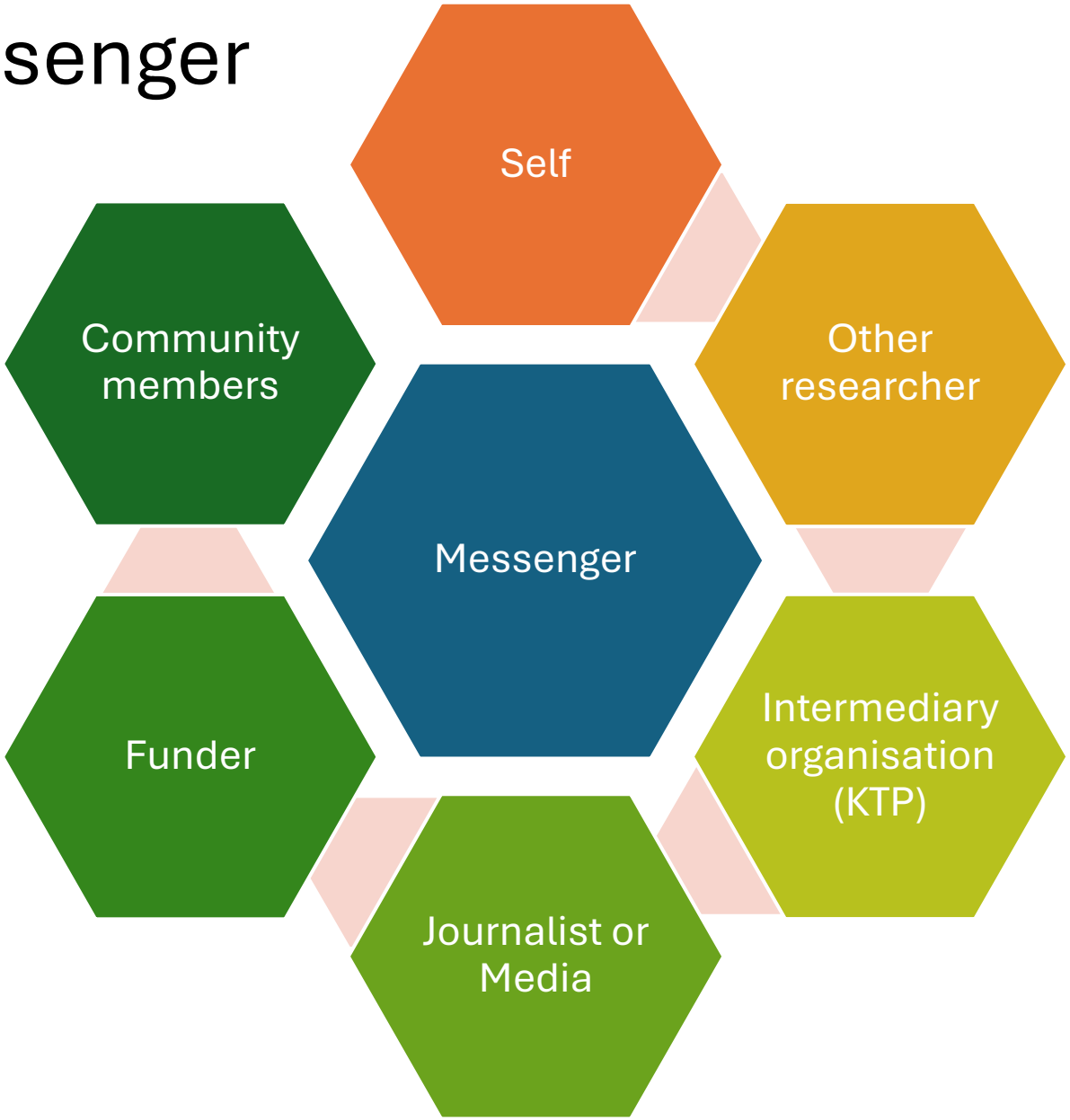
Instagram



WhatsApp groups

Visuals partly generated with Microsoft Copilot. Social media icons are trademarks of their respective owners.

5. WHOM? Messenger



6. WHEN? Timing



7. HOW MUCH / HOW MANY? Resources



Tools



Funding

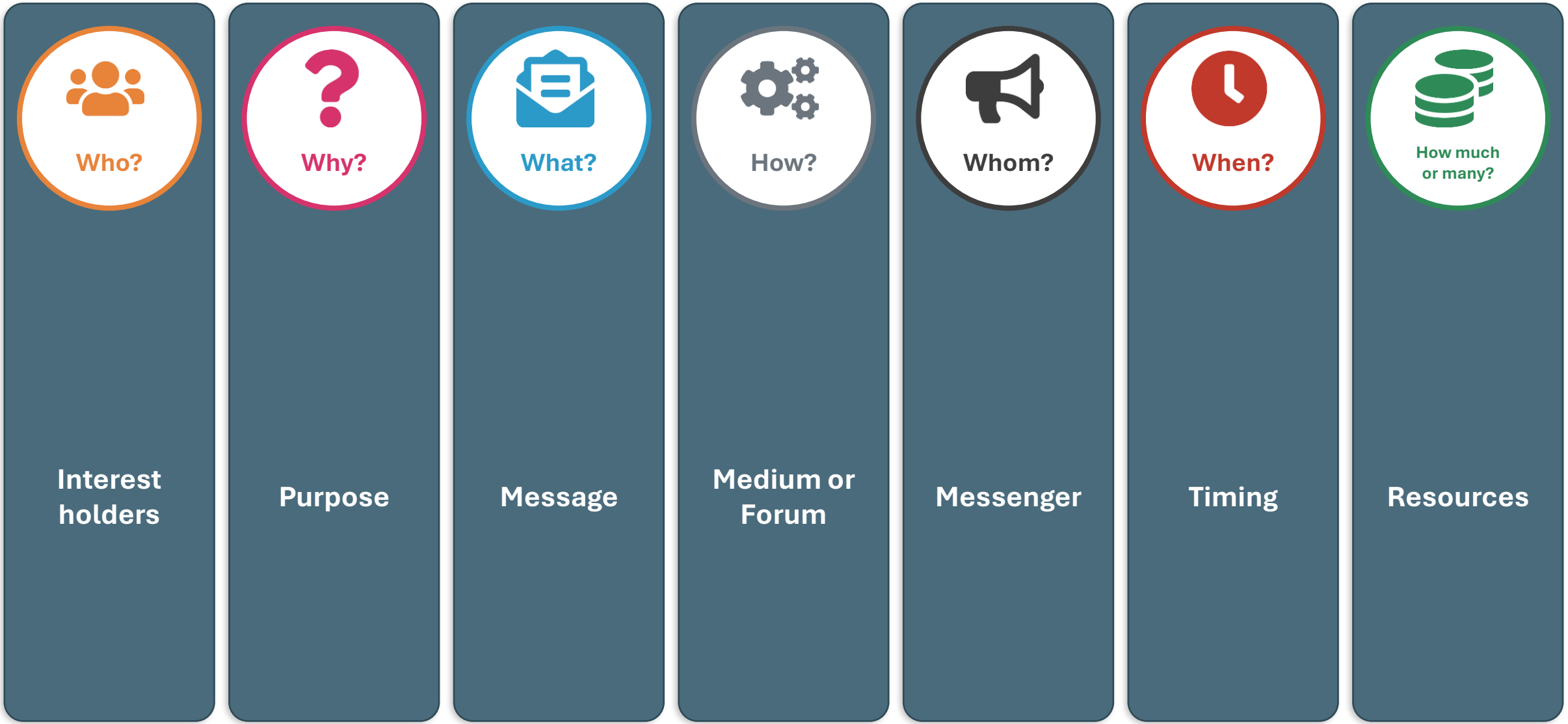


Time



People time

KNOWLEDGE TRANSLATION STRATEGY



Planning for and monitoring your KT engagement strategy

Stakeholder 1: Director of Child Health, Western Cape Province							
Goal/Purpose of Engagement (Raise awareness/interest, Inform, clarify, effect policy/practice/public action)	**Main Message**	**Medium** (PolicyBrief, Manuscript, report, Podcast Video, Blogshot, Interview, etc)	**Forum/Vehicle** (Conference, Face-Face, Email, Radio, Twitter, Telephone etc)	**Messenger** (Self, Colleague, Media, intermediary/Broker, Funder, Community member, etc…)	**Timing**	**Resources** (Time, Human, Financial, tools)	**Measuring uptake** (see **sheet: Measuring uptake key** for details)
1. Raise awareness about GELA	Objectives of GELA	SAMRC Website	Email	Tamara Kredo	31-May	Time (15 minutes)	Type of indicator: Usefulness (e.g. read the email) Indicator: Response Data collection method: Email Timing: Within 4 weeks of emailing them
2. Inform about a GELA scientific meeting							Type of indicator: Indicator: Data collection method: Timing:

- This is what we use – called a “tracking sheet”.
- Takes effort to keep updated
- The “tracking sheet” is only one form of data collection.
- Other forms of data collection could be the interviews and case stories with KT champions and specific stakeholders.



Group work

Instructions

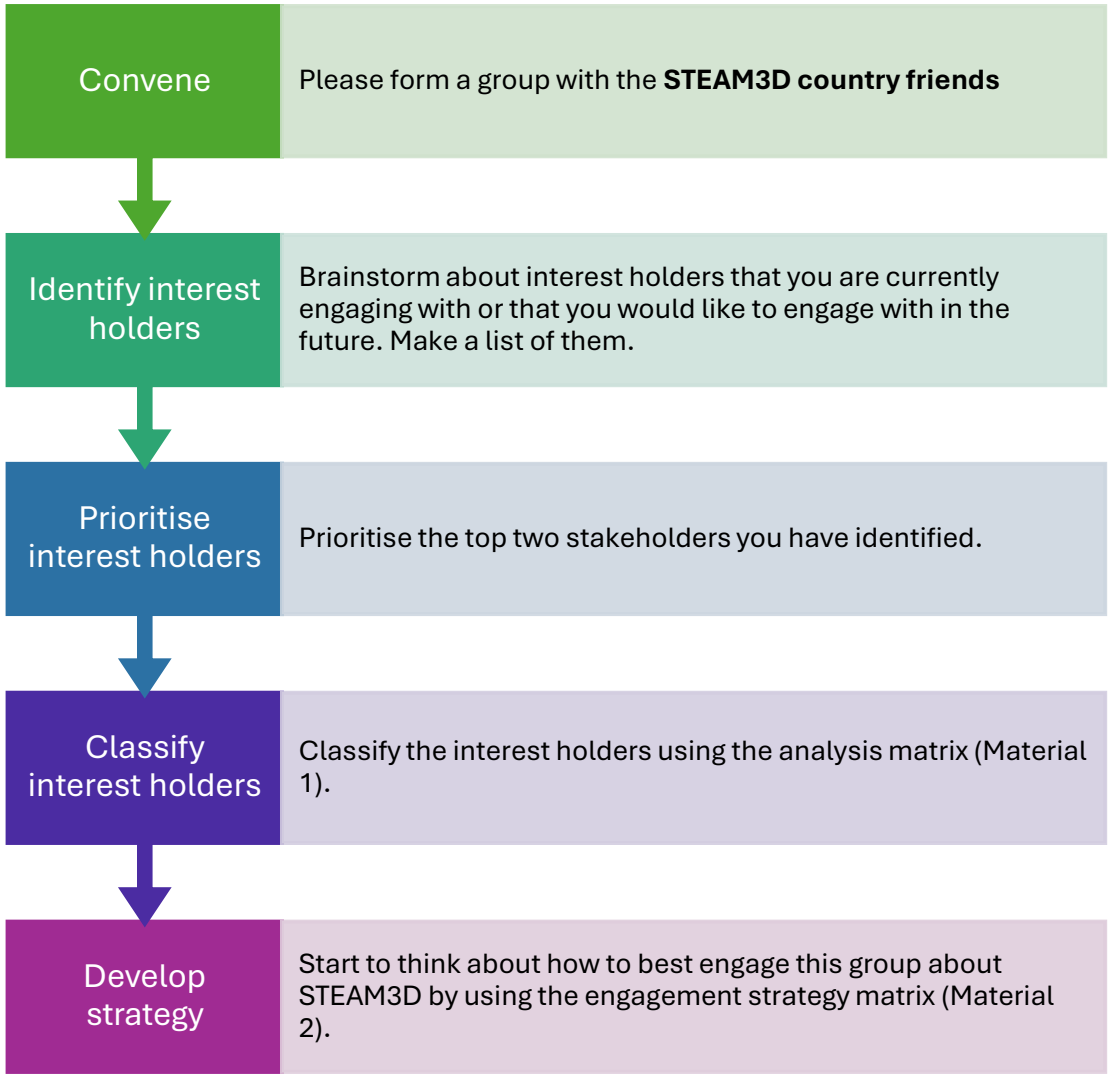
Purpose:
increase awareness of STEAM3D in your country

Time: 30 minutes
Choose a rapporteur

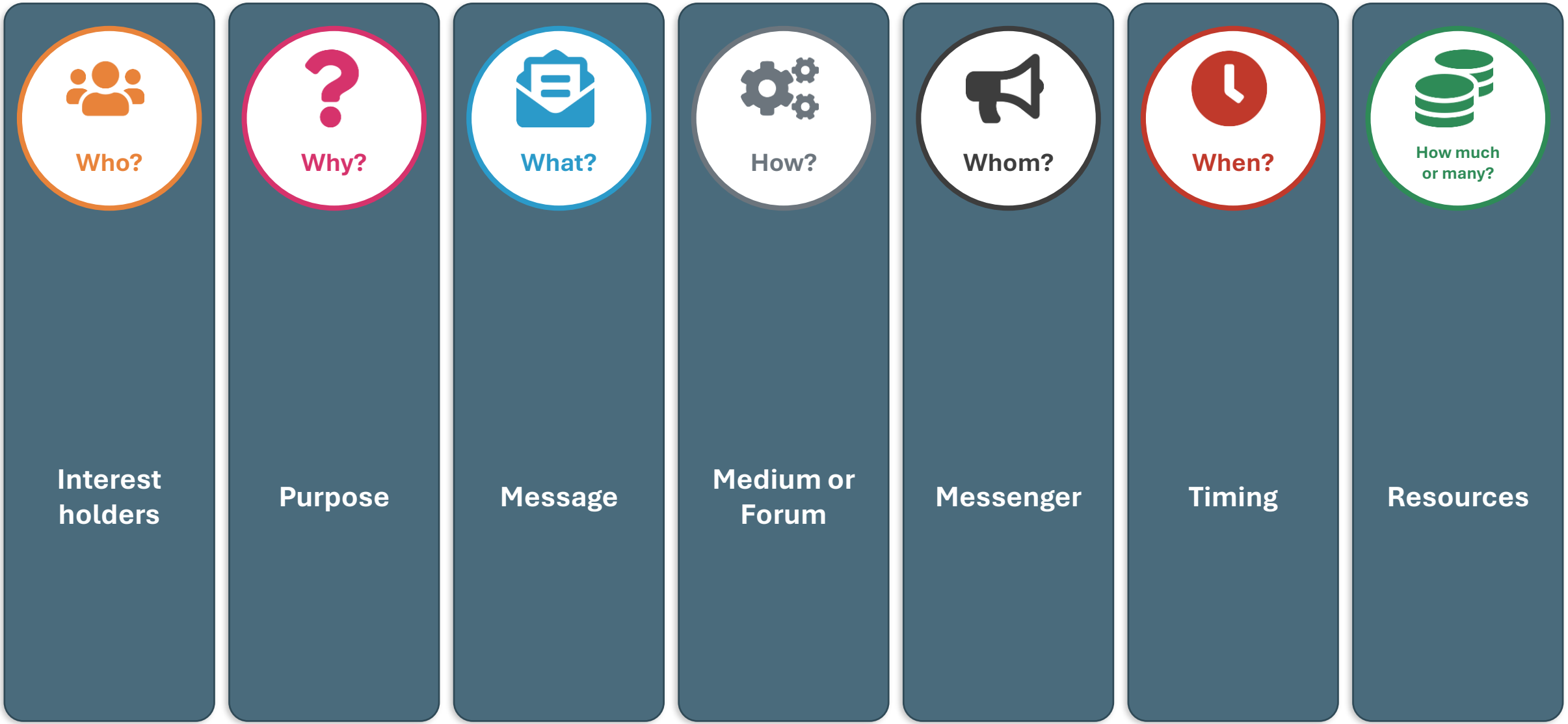
THREE minutes **feedback verbally for** each country on
1) choice of two interest holders = top priority
2) classify by power/ interest matrix

Active Resisters **Blockers**	Active Supporters **Champions**
Passive Resisters **Avoiders**	Passive Supporters **Silent Boosters**

Report back list:
Malawi
Mozambique
Cameroon
South Africa



KNOWLEDGE TRANSLATION STRATEGY



Thank you

Primer for STEAM3D delegates

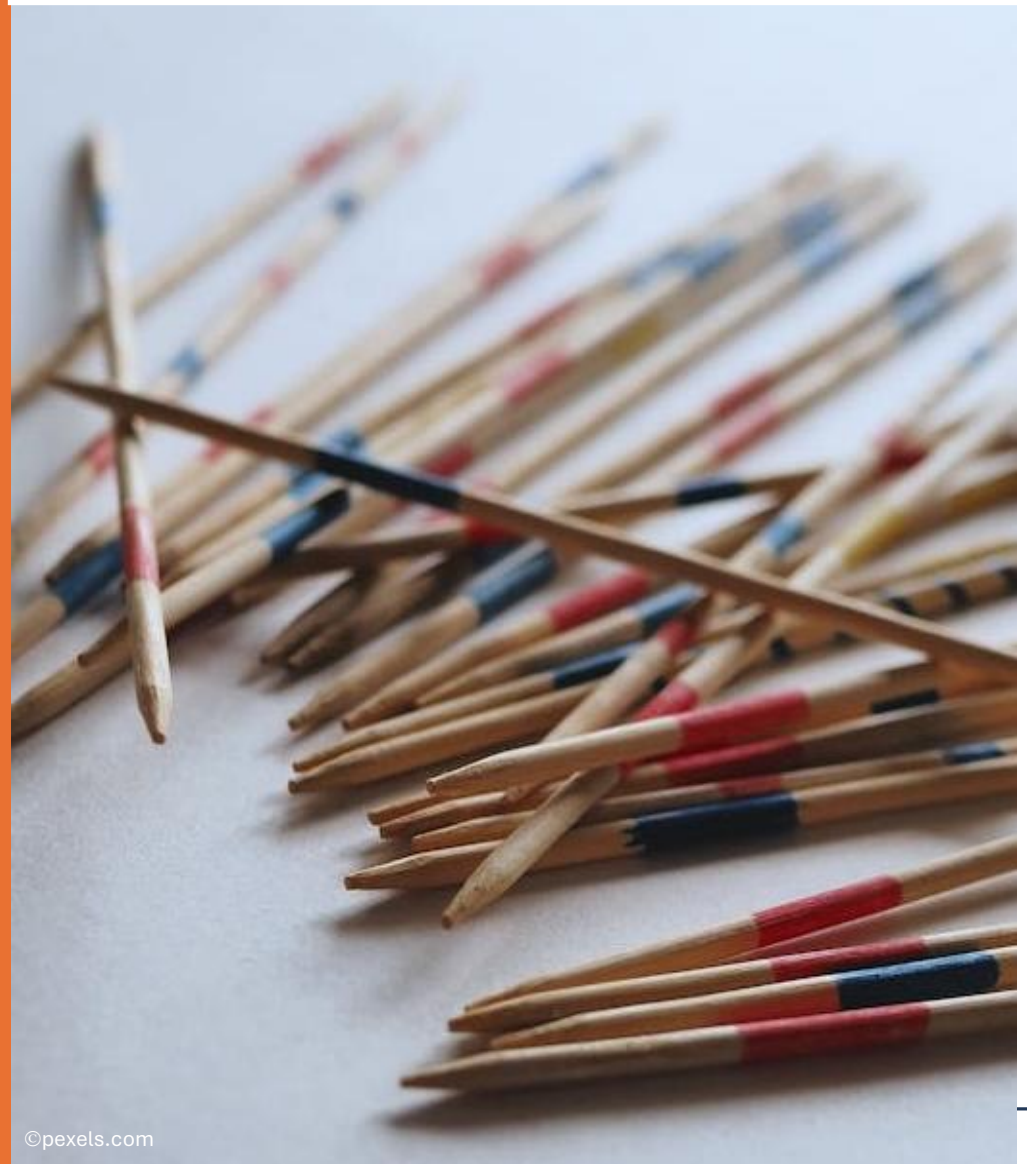
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STATUS QUO: FRAGMENTATION



Acknowledgement Tanja Kuchenmüller, WHO Science Division, Guidelines International Network, Plenary

Crowded health decision ecosystem

Clinicians, regulators, payers, policymakers, and communities each play a role in shaping healthcare, often operating in silos.

Evidence overload with disconnected processes

Despite robust methodologies like systematic reviews and health technology assessments, different groups often interpret or apply evidence independently

Parallel, non-transparent decision-making

Variations in framing, economic models, and contextual assumptions lead to divergent conclusions even when using the same evidence base.

Consequences: waste, confusion, distrust

Uncoordinated efforts result in duplication, contradictions, inefficiencies, and eroded confidence in health systems.

A UNIFYING FRAMEWORK

Based on country experience
Informed by pioneering work in Estonia and lessons from national implementation efforts.

Rooted in evidence-based medicine
Builds on legacy of GRADE, EtD frameworks, and other methodology innovations.

Iterative development with global interest-holders
Engagements with ministries, NGOs, researchers, and clinicians across multiple regions.



©Edho Pratama/Unsplash

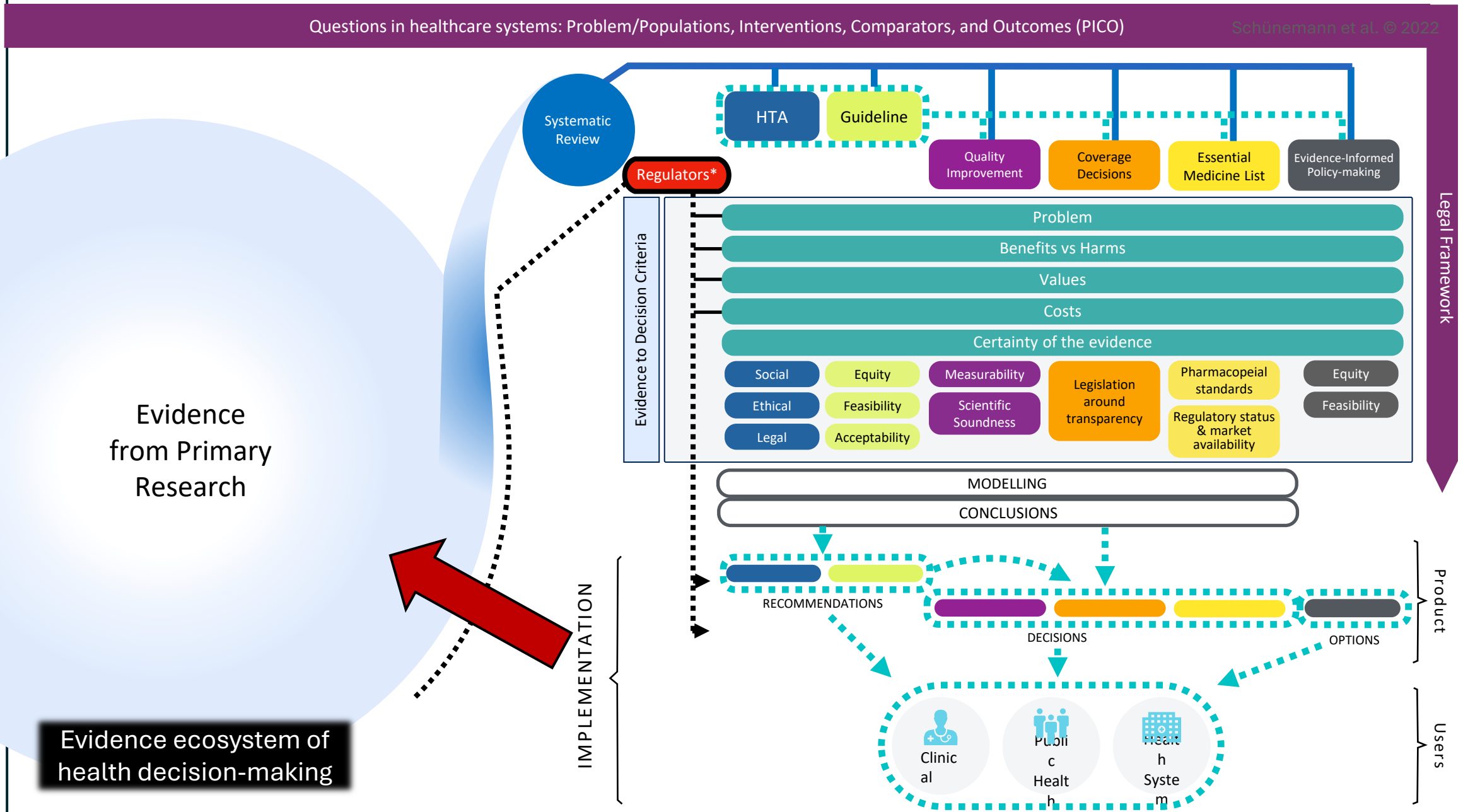
A UNIFYING FRAMEWORK

- Identify and map common building blocks
- Create a shared architecture and build bridges
- Enable context-specific adaptation



Schünemann HJ et al. Lancet Public Health. 2022;7(4):e378–90

THE INTERCONNECTEDNESS OF HEALTH DECISIONS ACROSS DISCIPLINES



Knowledge translation

Term	Typical use or emphasis
Knowledge mobilisation (KMb)	Canada (social sciences) and the UK; emphasises making knowledge active and usable
Knowledge transfer	Older term; suggests a one-way flow from researchers to users
Knowledge exchange	Two-way learning between researchers and users; common in the UK
Knowledge transfer and exchange (KTE)	Combined term used in Canada, for example in health services research
Research translation	Australia; also used for moving research into practice
Translational research	Often means "bench to bedside" (T1–T4 stages), so it is narrower than KT
Research utilisation	Nursing literature; using research findings in practice
Research uptake	Common in UK-funded and international development research
Research impact	UK (REF) and Australia; focuses on the effects of research
Dissemination and implementation (D&I)	US (NIH)
Implementation science / implementation research	The science of how to get evidence into routine practice
Evidence uptake / evidence use	Common in EIDM and policy work
Evidence-to-policy / research-to-policy	Policy-focused KT, for example WHO EVIPNet
Knowledge-to-action (KTA)	The Graham et al. framework; also used as a general term
Knowledge brokering	The intermediary role between research and decision-makers
Knowledge management	Organisational use; managing and sharing internal knowledge
Knowledge diffusion / diffusion of innovations	Spread of new ideas (Rogers)
Research into practice / getting research into practice (GRIP)	Clinical and practice settings
Scaling up / spread	Moving proven interventions to wider use
Co-production / integrated KT (iKT)	Researchers and knowledge users working together throughout
Science communication / public engagement	Communicating research to the public
Valorisation	Used in Europe, especially the Netherlands

McKibbon KA, et al. *Implementation Science* 2010;5:16



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